



MONTHLY UPDATE

Benin: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-20 · 26 systems and instruments tracked, 5 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-20 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Three instruments were issued in the eight days to 31 July. On 24 July a joint circular required every state structure to [digitise its paper records](#), stating printing, archiving and carbon costs as the returns. On 28 July the digital agency published the [conditions of access](#) to the national data exchange, which include authorisation by the data-protection authority before a private body may first connect. On 31 July the same agency opened drafting of a [national DPI roadmap](#), whose stated aim is that the state stop asking citizens for documents it issued itself.

On 16 July the identity agency's director general stated the birth-registration gap: [about 2.5m births declared between 2021 and 2025 against under 1m registered](#). A single-window pilot at ten maternities [raised registration to 76.56%](#); its wider rollout has slipped.

A full read of the state's estimates volumes, dated 25 July, establishes that the data-protection authority carries its own budget line across three years while the digital agency that runs the CSIRT, the data centre and the PKI has no visible line in any of them.

Infrastructure

Strategies, plans and policies

The Cotonou cyber-hub programme now carries four parts: hosting the continental cyber forum, [a cybersecurity-only incubator at Abomey-Calavi](#), a statewide risk-management framework with a crisis exercise for state information-security officers, and [300 police unit heads trained during 2026](#).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Benin is [ranked fourth in Africa on a 2026 internet-freedom assessment](#) — a reference ranking, cited here and not absorbed into the ledger as a position of the state's own.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

The exchange [recorded more than 138 million requests in total](#), 32.7m in the preceding thirty days, across 73 members, 176 information systems and 512 services.

A second kind of data exchange entered the record in August, and it is regional rather than national. The BIC-UEMOA credit information bureau held its first Cotonou data forum on 23 July, [reported on 13 August](#), with the finance ministry framing data quality as the route to cutting credit-approval turnaround to 48 hours. The bureau spans all eight union states with 321 data providers, about 48 million contracts and more than 20 million active borrowers. The figures are the operator's own and union-wide; nothing Benin-specific — coverage, dispute rate or the data-protection basis for the file — is held.

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

On 16 July the identity agency's director general set out the birth-registration gap and the single-window remedy at ten maternities.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The [justice sector's 2026–2033 plan](#) commits to a case-tracking portal, secure hosting of judicial instruments and digitally integrated legal aid. It names no budget, no sequencing and no implementing agency.

Strategies, plans and policies

Two instruments moved in opposite directions on the same problem. A [joint circular of 24 July requires every state structure to move archive and procedure management onto digital tools](#), with the returns stated as fiscal and environmental rather than as service improvement, and with no implementation deadline, budget line, scope definition or compliance mechanism; the circular's own text is not published. Against that, a [national digital public infrastructure roadmap is in draft on a once-only principle](#) — the state ceasing to ask citizens for documents it issued itself — with the agency framing the hard part as governance and coherence across infrastructure already built rather than as further building.

Regional collaboration

The customs administrations of Nigeria, Cameroon and Benin [adopted a joint communiqué on 27 July establishing a trilateral steering committee](#) to apply a southern African border-modernisation model to the Sèmè-Kraké and Mfum-Ekok corridors, after a benchmarking mission whose technical team included two named private suppliers alongside the three administrations. Separately, the cross-border digital identity work Benin does through Smart Africa moved from development into a running pilot: [an identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now being recognised in the other two](#), with eighteen further countries said to be joining and no date given for any of them.

Standards

Interoperability gained its rules and its gatekeeper in the same month. The [conditions of access to the national exchange were published on 28 July](#): registration in the interoperable-solutions catalogue, demonstrated data governance, compatible infrastructure, and a convention per exchange naming data, purposes, responsibilities and security measures — and, for a private body, an adhesion convention plus data-protection authority authorisation before first connection. That places the authority inside the technical onboarding path rather than at the end of it as a complaint channel. No fee schedule, processing time or count of authorised participants is stated. The [national root certification authority and trust services are operating](#), and architecture and application-integration referentials went out to consultation on the same date, intended to end siloed platform-building.

National statistics

The digital agency published these exchange-usage figures on 11 July.

Governance and regulation

Open data

The Open Government Partnership national action plan's co-creation opened at the end of the month, eighteen months after the country joined. Nothing moved this month on data protection or the digital-strategy stack.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

A [US\\$2.3m malaria programme combining artificial intelligence, drones and geospatial mapping reports incidence down 38% and mortality down 39% across 2022 to 2024](#), on Japanese financing. The reductions are the programme's own account and no independent evaluation is held.

Regional collaboration

Benin [co-leads a six-country francophone West African framework on artificial-intelligence governance](#), taken to the United Nations global dialogue on 9 July. The framework is in development and no text, timetable or commitment is held.

AI

A [four-country comparative study presented on 10 August found no AI-specific legislation in force or in draft in Benin](#), which leaves the 2023-2027 national strategy carrying the field on its own. The same study rates Cote d'Ivoire's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance, and finds Burkina Faso's data-protection law the only one of the four to name AI-based processing explicitly.

ICT Industry

A domestic content-verification platform founded in 2025 was profiled on 27 July; it checks text, images, audio and video, including AI-generated content.

Literacy

A co-author of the national artificial-intelligence strategy [published a build-an-LLM-from-scratch book arguing for frugal domestic artificial intelligence](#), its sharpest claim being a scarcity of graphics processors turning artificial intelligence into a luxury good.

Training and skills

The [first national artificial-intelligence olympiad was held on 9 July](#). No entry numbers, institutions or results are published.

Inclusion and capacity

Training and skills

The Council of Ministers authorised a national tele-teaching platform across four public universities for 2026–27, with virtual amphitheatres for students in the hinterland. Two skills programmes ran alongside it. The state's information-systems security officer certification [opened a cohort of 25 on 3 August, taking about 85 officers trained against a target of 100 qualified by end-2026, on CEH and ISO 27001 with practical work at the national cyber range, and widened intake beyond central government to local authorities, state enterprises and the private sector](#). The Sème City hub network runs a francophone digital-skills programme and an annual digital week [alongside a Sorbonne partnership](#); no enrolment or completion figure is published for it.

Benin held a first National AI Olympiad on 9 July. Nothing moved on the national strategy itself, on the generative-AI compliance regime published in June, or on the government super app the presidential programme lists among its existing foundations and which nothing establishes.

Finance

New investments

One commitment entered the window. During a ministerial visit of 4 to 6 August, Canada [announced CAD5m for the digital transformation of women-led businesses, one of seven projects in a package of about CAD17m for Benin and West Africa](#). The remaining six lines are outside the digital estate. What the digital line does not carry is an implementing partner, a start date or a duration, so there is nothing yet to follow from the announcement to a system.

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